VOLUME 6

Reader Questions

Questions on Difficult Bible Verses



READERS QUESTION SERIES

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HOW TO READ THIS VOLUME

Each entry takes one question a reader has asked about one verse or short passage. This volume takes ten questions on psalms that the New Testament quotes. Each entry states what the verse means, and then argues that meaning from the verse's own passage and the chapter or chapters before it. The Scripture elsewhere is used as support, not as the foundation. Each entry marks what the text states, what the context shows, and what is inferred, so that the reader can see what carries the weight and judge it. The entries argue a position. Where other readings are held by named writers, they are set beside it with the places where each strains.

Scripture is quoted from the King James Version (KJV). Modern writers are named by author and work; their views are described in the entry's own words, and no quotation marks are used for them.

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1. Why Did Jesus Cry “My God, My God, Why Hast Thou Forsaken Me?”

Matthew 27:46 & Psalm 22:1

THE ANSWER

Jesus speaks the first line of Psalm 22 at the end of the darkness, and the forsaking is real in the hour of the cross. Matthew has already built the scene from Psalm 22 before the cry. The psalm itself turns from abandonment to being heard, and Hebrews places its praise in His mouth. The Gospels do not explain the forsaking; Paul gives that explanation to the Body.

Where the Verses Stand

Matthew records the crucifixion in order: garments parted, heads wagged, taunts spoken, darkness falling, and the cry at the ninth hour. Psalm 22 describes the mocked sufferer and the turning to praise. The setting is Israel’s, and Matthew uses the psalm’s details before the cry.

Verse	KJV text	What to observe
Ps 22:1–2	“My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me? why art thou so far from helping me, and from the words of my roaring? O my God, I cry in the daytime, but thou hearest not; and in the night season, and am not silent.”	The question “why”; the sufferer says “thou hearest not.”
Ps 22:7–8, 18	“All they that see me laugh me to scorn: they shoot out the lip, they shake the head, saying, He trusted on the LORD that he would deliver him: let him deliver him, seeing he delighted in him.” … “They part my garments among them, and cast lots upon my vesture.”	“They shake the head”; “He trusted on the LORD”; “They part my garments.”
Mt 27:35	“And they crucified him, and parted his garments, casting lots: that it might be fulfilled which was spoken by the prophet, They parted my garments among them, and upon my vesture did they cast lots.”	The garments are parted, as in Psalm 22:18.

Mt 27:39–43	"And they that passed by reviled him, wagging their heads, And saying, Thou that destroyest the temple, and buildest it in three days, save thyself. If thou be the Son of God, come down from the cross. Likewise also the chief priests mocking him, with the scribes and elders, said, He saved others; himself he cannot save. If he be the King of Israel, let him now come down from the cross, and we will believe him. He trusted in God; let him deliver him now, if he will have him: for he said, I am the Son of God."	Heads wagged and "He trusted in God," as in Psalm 22:7–8.
Mt 27:45–47	"Now from the sixth hour there was darkness over all the land unto the ninth hour. And about the ninth hour Jesus cried with a loud voice, saying, Eli, Eli, lama sabachthani? that is to say, My God, my God, why hast thou forsaken me? Some of them that stood there, when they heard that, said, This man calleth for Elias."	Darkness, the cry in Aramaic with its meaning, and the bystanders hearing "Elias."
Ps 22:21, 24	"Save me from the lion's mouth: for thou hast heard me from the horns of the unicorns." … "For he hath not despised nor abhorred the affliction of the afflicted; neither hath he hid his face from him; but when he cried unto him, he heard."	"Thou hast heard me"; "when he cried unto him, he heard."
Lk 23:46	"And when Jesus had cried with a loud voice, he said, Father, into thy hands I commend my spirit: and having said thus, he gave up the ghost."	Luke records a different word at the same hour: "Father, into thy hands I commend my spirit."
Heb 2:10–12	"For it became him, for whom are all things, and by whom are all things, in bringing many sons unto glory, to make the captain of their salvation perfect through sufferings. For both he that sanctifieth and they who are sanctified are all of one: for which cause he is not ashamed to call them brethren, Saying, I will declare thy name unto my brethren, in the midst of the church will I sing praise unto thee."	Hebrews puts Psalm 22:22 in his mouth: "I will declare thy name unto my brethren."

What Carries the Weight

Stated: the cry is spoken with a loud voice at the ninth hour.

Shown by the context: Matthew has already used Psalm 22's details.

Inferred: the forsaking is real, not merely felt.

Inferred: Paul's explanation belongs to the Body and is not read back into the Gospels.

The Other Readings

Real abandonment: must explain Psalm 22:24 and John 16:32.

Quotation of the whole psalm: must explain the question “why” and the darkness.

Felt, not real: must explain why the Gospels record the cry at all.

Reading	What it must say	Where it strains
A real abandonment	The Father turned away at the cross.	Psalm 22:24; John 16:32.
Quotation of the whole psalm	The cry points to the vindication.	“Why”; the darkness; the Aramaic kept.
Felt, not real	The Son felt forsaken; the Father did not leave.	“Forsaken” is asked as a real question.

What It Means for the Reader

The cry belongs to the psalm’s scene and its answer. The reader does not build a doctrine of the Godhead on one line. The Body receives Paul’s explanation of the cross.

Related Reading

Commentary Series: Typology Commentary, Volume 1 (the rent veil). **Companions:** Psalms; Matthew; Mark.

2. What Does “Ye Are Gods” Mean in John 10:34 and Psalm 82:6?

Human judges, divine beings, or something else?

THE ANSWER

Psalm 82 addresses Israel’s judges, who stand in God’s place and judge unjustly. Jesus quotes the line to answer a charge of blasphemy: if Scripture calls those who received God’s word “gods,” He whom the Father sanctified does not blaspheme in saying He is the Son of God. His claim rests on His works and His oneness with the Father.

Where the Verses Stand

John 10 places the scene at the feast of dedication. The charge is blasphemy. Psalm 82 charges unjust judges and calls them “gods” who will die like men. Exodus 22 uses the same Hebrew word for human judges.

Verse	KJV text	What to observe
Ps 82:1–4	“God standeth in the congregation of the mighty; he judgeth among the gods. How long will ye judge unjustly, and accept the persons of the wicked? Selah. Defend the poor and fatherless: do justice to the afflicted and needy. Deliver the poor and needy: rid them out of the hand of the wicked.”	God judges “among the gods”; the charge is unjust judging; the duty is to defend the poor.
Ps 82:6–8	“I have said, Ye are gods; and all of you are children of the most High. But ye shall die like men, and fall like one of the princes. Arise, O God, judge the earth: for thou shalt inherit all nations.”	“Ye are gods … children of the most High. But ye shall die like men.”
Ex 22:8–9	“If the thief be not found, then the master of the house shall be brought unto the judges, to see whether he have put his hand unto his neighbour's goods. For all manner of trespass, whether it be for ox, for ass, for sheep, for raiment, or for any manner of lost thing, which another challengeth to be his, the cause of both parties shall come before the judges; and whom the judges shall condemn, he shall pay double unto his neighbour.”	The KJV has the matter come “unto the judges.” The Hebrew word is the one the KJV translates *gods* in Psalm 82:1.

Jn 10:30–33	"I and my Father are one. Then the Jews took up stones again to stone him. Jesus answered them, Many good works have I shewed you from my Father; for which of those works do ye stone me? The Jews answered him, saying, For a good work we stone thee not; but for blasphemy; and because that thou, being a man, makest thyself God."	"I and my Father are one"; the charge: "makest thyself God."
Jn 10:34–36	"Jesus answered them, Is it not written in your law, I said, Ye are gods? If he called them gods, unto whom the word of God came, and the scripture cannot be broken; Say ye of him, whom the Father hath sanctified, and sent into the world, Thou blasphemest; because I said, I am the Son of God?"	"Is it not written in your law, I said, Ye are gods?" Those "unto whom the word of God came."
Jn 10:37–38	"If I do not the works of my Father, believe me not. But if I do, though ye believe not me, believe the works: that ye may know, and believe, that the Father is in me, and I in him."	His own answer: "believe the works."

What Carries the Weight

Stated: Jesus calls it "your law" and names those addressed as those who received God's word.

Shown by the context: Psalm 82 addresses unjust judges who will die like men.

Inferred: Jesus argues from lesser to greater.

The Other Readings

Heavenly council: strains at "die like men."

Israel at Sinai: strains at the charge of unjust judging.

Human judges: fits the charge and the mortality.

Reading	What it must say	Where it strains
A heavenly council	The "gods" are divine beings.	"Unto whom the word of God came"; "die like men."
Israel at Sinai	The "gods" are the nation that received the Torah.	The charge of unjust judging in verses 2–4.
Israel's judges	The "gods" are rulers who judged in God's place.	"Children of the most High"; the opening in heaven.

What It Means for the Reader

The verse does not teach that believers become gods. Jesus uses Scripture to silence a charge and then points to His works.

Related Reading

Commentary Series: Gospel Commentary, Volume 2 (The Lord's Ministry to Israel); Volume 4 (What the Twelve Understood). **Companions:** Psalms; John.

3. Why Did Satan Quote Psalm 91 to Jesus?

Matthew 4:6 & Psalm 91:11–12

THE ANSWER

Satan quotes Psalm 91 accurately but omits “in all thy ways,” turning a promise for the one who trusts God into a test of God. Jesus answers from Deuteronomy 6:16. The psalm is true; the use is false.

Where the Verses Stand

Matthew 4 records three temptations, each answered from Deuteronomy. Psalm 91 promises protection to the one who dwells with God. The devil quotes the promise without its condition.

Verse	KJV text	What to observe
Ps 91:1–2	“He that dwelleth in the secret place of the most High shall abide under the shadow of the Almighty. I will say of the LORD, He is my refuge and my fortress: my God; in him will I trust.”	The one who dwells in the secret place says “He is my refuge.”
Ps 91:9–12	“Because thou hast made the LORD, which is my refuge, even the most High, thy habitation; There shall no evil befall thee, neither shall any plague come nigh thy dwelling. For he shall give his angels charge over thee, to keep thee in all thy ways. They shall bear thee up in their hands, lest thou dash thy foot against a stone.”	“Because thou hast made the LORD … thy habitation”; “to keep thee in all thy ways.”
Mt 4:5–7	“Then the devil taketh him up into the holy city, and setteth him on a pinnacle of the temple, And saith unto him, If thou be the Son of God, cast thyself down: for it is written, He shall give his angels charge concerning thee: and in their hands they shall bear thee up, lest at any time thou dash thy foot against a stone. Jesus said unto him, It is written again, Thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God.”	“It is written”; the quotation stops at the stone; “It is written again.”
Lk 4:9–12	“And he brought him to Jerusalem, and set him on a pinnacle of the temple, and said unto him, If thou be the Son of God, cast thyself down from hence: For it is written, He shall give his angels charge over thee, to keep thee: And in their hands they shall bear thee up, lest at any time thou dash thy foot against a stone. And Jesus answering said unto him, It is said, Thou shalt not tempt the Lord thy God.”	Luke gives the quotation with “to keep thee,” and the same answer.

Dt 6:16	"Ye shall not tempt the LORD your God, as ye tempted him in Massah."	"Ye shall not tempt the LORD your God, as ye tempted him in Massah."
Ex 17:7	"And he called the name of the place Massah, and Meribah, because of the chiding of the children of Israel, and because they tempted the LORD, saying, Is the LORD among us, or not?"	Massah: "Is the LORD among us, or not?"

What Carries the Weight

Stated: Satan says "it is written"; Jesus says "it is written again."

Shown by the context: the promise rests on trust and "thy ways."

Inferred: the omission is deliberate; the use is presumption.

The Other Readings

Misquotation: strains because the words are correct.

Unconditional promise: strains at "Thou shalt not tempt."

Promise misused: fits the Lord's answer.

Reading	What it must say	Where it strains
A misquotation	Satan changed the words.	The words are in the psalm.
An unconditional promise	Any believer may count on the angels.	"Because thou hast made the LORD … thy habitation"; "Thou shalt not tempt."
A promise used to presume	The promise stands; the leap is the sin.	None; it follows the Lord's own answer.

What It Means for the Reader

Psalm 91 is not doubted and not proved. Scripture must be used in its setting.

Related Reading

Companions: Psalms; Matthew; Luke.

4. What Does “What Is Man” Mean in Psalm 8 and Hebrews 2?

Dominion, the Son of Man, and the world to come

THE ANSWER

Psalm 8 marvels at man’s place over God’s works. Hebrews reads the psalm in light of the world to come: the rule is not yet seen, but Jesus is seen, made lower and crowned. Hebrews applies the psalm to the Son of man and to Israel’s hope.

Where the Verses Stand

Hebrews 2 speaks of the world to come and quotes Psalm 8. The readers are Hebrews. Psalm 8 speaks of man’s dominion.

Verse	KJV text	What to observe
Ps 8:3–6	“When I consider thy heavens, the work of thy fingers, the moon and the stars, which thou hast ordained; What is man, that thou art mindful of him? and the son of man, that thou visitest him? For thou hast made him a little lower than the angels, and hast crowned him with glory and honour. Thou madest him to have dominion over the works of thy hands; thou hast put all things under his feet:”	“What is man … and the son of man”; “a little lower than the angels”; “all things under his feet.”
Heb 2:5–8	“For unto the angels hath he not put in subjection the world to come, whereof we speak. But one in a certain place testified, saying, What is man, that thou art mindful of him? or the son of man, that thou visitest him? Thou madest him a little lower than the angels; thou crownedst him with glory and honour, and didst set him over the works of thy hands: Thou hast put all things in subjection under his feet. For in that he put all in subjection under him, he left nothing that is not put under him. But now we see not yet all things put under him.”	“The world to come, whereof we speak”; the quotation; “now we see not yet all things put under him.”
Heb 2:9	“But we see Jesus, who was made a little lower than the angels for the suffering of death, crowned with glory and honour; that he by the grace of God should taste death for every man.”	“But we see Jesus” made lower and crowned.
Heb 2:16	“For verily he took not on him the nature of angels; but he took on him the seed of Abraham.”	“The seed of Abraham.”

Mt 21:15–16	"And when the chief priests and scribes saw the wonderful things that he did, and the children crying in the temple, and saying, Hosanna to the Son of David; they were sore displeased, And said unto him, Hearest thou what these say? And Jesus saith unto them, Yea; have ye never read, Out of the mouth of babes and sucklings thou hast perfected praise?"	The Lord quotes Psalm 8:2 to the chief priests about the children's praise.
1 Cor 15:25–27	"For he must reign, till he hath put all enemies under his feet. The last enemy that shall be destroyed is death. For he hath put all things under his feet. But when he saith, all things are put under him, it is manifest that he is excepted, which did put all things under him."	Paul quotes "all things under his feet" of Christ's reign, to the Body.

What Carries the Weight

Stated: the world to come is the subject.

Shown by the context: the rule is not yet seen; Jesus is.

Inferred: Hebrews reads the psalm in Israel's hope; Paul uses the same line differently for the Body.

The Other Readings

Christ alone: strains at the psalm's "man."

Humanity alone: strains at Hebrews' "we see Jesus."

Both in order: fits the text.

Reading	What it must say	Where it strains
Humanity in general	The psalm is about every man.	"The world to come"; "not yet."
The Messiah only	The psalm is about Christ from the start.	"What is man"; "babes and sucklings."
Man's rule, seen first in Jesus	The psalm states the appointment; Hebrews shows its first sight.	None; it joins both texts.

What It Means for the Reader

The psalm's wonder is fulfilled in Jesus and awaits the world to come.

Related Reading

Companions: Psalms; Hebrews; Matthew.

5. Should Believers Pray the Cursing Psalms?

Psalm 69, Psalm 109, and Acts 1:20

THE ANSWER

Psalm 69 and 109 are David's prayers against enemies. Acts 1 quotes Psalm 69:25 and 109:8 in Israel's setting. The Body is not told to pray these psalms as its own. They are Scripture, but their setting is Israel's.

Where the Verses Stand

Psalm 69 and 109 speak of enemies and judgment. Acts 1 applies them to Judas in Israel's program.

Verse	KJV text	What to observe
Ps 69:25	"Let their habitation be desolate; and let none dwell in their tents."	"Let their habitation be desolate."
Ps 109:4–8	"For my love they are my adversaries: but I give myself unto prayer. And they have rewarded me evil for good, and hatred for my love. Set thou a wicked man over him: and let Satan stand at his right hand. When he shall be judged, let him be condemned: and let his prayer become sin. Let his days be few; and let another take his office."	"I give myself unto prayer"; "Let his days be few; and let another take his office."
Ac 1:16–20	"Men and brethren, this scripture must needs have been fulfilled, which the Holy Ghost by the mouth of David spake before concerning Judas, which was guide to them that took Jesus." … "For it is written in the book of Psalms, Let his habitation be desolate, and let no man dwell therein: and his bishoprick let another take."	"The Holy Ghost by the mouth of David spake … concerning Judas"; the two verses joined.
Mt 5:44	"But I say unto you, Love your enemies, bless them that curse you, do good to them that hate you, and pray for them which despitefully use you, and persecute you;"	The Lord's word to Israel's disciples: "Love your enemies."
Rom 12:14, 19	"Bless them which persecute you: bless, and curse not." … "Dearly beloved, avenge not yourselves, but rather give place unto wrath: for it is written, Vengeance is mine; I will repay, saith the Lord."	To the Body: "bless, and curse not"; "avenge not yourselves."
2 Tim 4:14	"Alexander the coppersmith did me much evil: the Lord reward him according to his works:"	Paul leaves Alexander with "the Lord reward him according to his works."

What Carries the Weight

Stated: the psalms speak from David's place.

Shown by the context: Acts uses them in Israel's setting.

Inferred: the Body is not given these prayers as its own.

The Other Readings

For all believers: strains at Israel's setting.

Never for believers: strains at their place in Scripture.

For Israel's setting: fits Acts 1.

Reading	What it must say	Where it strains
Pray them as written	The Body may pray the curses.	"Bless, and curse not"; no command to pray them.
A lower ethic, replaced	The cursing was set aside.	"The Holy Ghost by the mouth of David."
Israel's prayers	The curses stand in Israel's line.	None; the Body's word is Romans 12.

What It Means for the Reader

The psalms are Scripture; their use belongs to their setting.

Related Reading

Commentary Series: Acts Commentary, Volume 1 (Acts 1–8). **Companions:** Psalms; Acts.

6. Does “Be Ye Angry, and Sin Not” Permit Anger?

Psalm 4:4 & Ephesians 4:26

THE ANSWER

Psalm 4:4 commands trembling and reflection. Paul quotes it to the Body and warns against sinning in anger. The psalm’s command is inward; Paul’s warning is practical.

Where the Verses Stand

Psalm 4 speaks of trembling before God. Ephesians 4 warns the Body about anger and its danger.

Verse	KJV text	What to observe
Ps 4:4	“Stand in awe, and sin not: commune with your own heart upon your bed, and be still. Selah.”	“Stand in awe, and sin not: commune with your own heart upon your bed, and be still.”
Eph 4:25–27	“Wherefore putting away lying, speak every man truth with his neighbour: for we are members one of another. Be ye angry, and sin not: let not the sun go down upon your wrath: Neither give place to the devil.”	Truth, then “Be ye angry, and sin not,” then “Neither give place to the devil.”
Eph 4:31	“Let all bitterness, and wrath, and anger, and clamour, and evil speaking, be put away from you, with all malice:”	“Let all bitterness, and wrath, and anger, and clamour … be put away from you.”

What Carries the Weight

Stated: the psalm commands trembling.

Shown by the context: Paul warns against anger’s danger.

Inferred: anger is not commended; restraint is commanded.

The Other Readings

Anger permitted: strains at Paul’s warning.

Anger forbidden: strains at Paul’s quotation.

Anger restrained: fits both.

Reading	What it must say	Where it strains
Anger is allowed	The believer may stay angry.	Ephesians 4:31; the sunset limit.
The Hebrew sense, “tremble”	Paul is loose with the psalm.	His wording matches the Greek translation.
A limited concession	Anger may rise; it may not sin or stay.	None; it joins 4:26 and 4:31.

What It Means for the Reader

Anger is not a virtue; restraint is.

Related Reading

Companions: Psalms; Ephesians.

7. Why Does Paul Say Christ "Gave Gifts" When Psalm 68 Says "Received"?

Ephesians 4:8 & Psalm 68:18

THE ANSWER

Psalm 68 speaks of the victor receiving gifts. Paul applies the victory to Christ and states the result for the Body: He gave gifts. The psalm's movement is upward; Paul's application is downward.

Where the Verses Stand

Psalm 68 celebrates God's victory. Ephesians 4 applies the victory to Christ's ascension.

Verse	KJV text	What to observe
Ps 68:17–18	"The chariots of God are twenty thousand, even thousands of angels: the Lord is among them, as in Sinai, in the holy place. Thou hast ascended on high, thou hast led captivity captive: thou hast received gifts for men; yea, for the rebellious also, that the LORD God might dwell among them."	God ascends "on high … led captivity captive … received gifts for men; yea, for the rebellious also."
Eph 4:7–10	"But unto every one of us is given grace according to the measure of the gift of Christ. Wherefore he saith, When he ascended up on high, he led captivity captive, and gave gifts unto men. (Now that he ascended, what is it but that he also descended first into the lower parts of the earth? He that descended is the same also that ascended up far above all heavens, that he might fill all things.)"	"Gave gifts unto men"; the ascent and the descent "into the lower parts of the earth."
Eph 4:11–13	"And he gave some, apostles; and some, prophets; and some, evangelists; and some, pastors and teachers; For the perfecting of the saints, for the work of the ministry, for the edifying of the body of Christ: Till we all come in the unity of the faith, and of the knowledge of the Son of God, unto a perfect man, unto the measure of the stature of the fulness of Christ:"	What he gave: apostles, prophets, evangelists, pastors and teachers.
Judg 5:12	"Awake, awake, Deborah: awake, awake, utter a song: arise, Barak, and lead thy captivity captive, thou son of Abinoam."	"Lead thy captivity captive," in Deborah's victory song.
Col 2:15	"And having spoiled principalities and powers, he made a shew of them openly, triumphing over them in it."	"Having spoiled principalities and powers … triumphing over them in it."

What Carries the Weight

Stated: the psalm says “received.”

Shown by the context: Paul applies the victory to Christ’s giving.

Inferred: the psalm’s movement allows Paul’s application.

The Other Readings

Contradiction: strains at Paul’s argument.

Different gifts: strains at the psalm’s movement.

Application: fits both.

Reading	What it must say	Where it strains
Paul misquotes	He changed “received” to “gave.”	He draws no attention to the change.
A different text	Paul used a paraphrase.	The letter names no source.
Receive and give	One triumph, two ends.	None; it joins both verbs.

What It Means for the Reader

Christ’s victory results in gifts for the Body.

Related Reading

Commentary Series: Prophecy & Mystery Commentary, Volume 2 (The Mystery Program); Pauline Doctrine Series, Volume 4 (The Assembly in Order). **Companions:** Psalms; Ephesians.

8. Does “A Thousand Years Is as One Day” Explain the Delay?

Psalm 90:4 & 2 Peter 3:8

THE ANSWER

Psalm 90 speaks of God’s eternity. Peter quotes it to answer scoffers and to show that delay does not deny promise. The psalm does not give a formula; Peter uses it to correct a charge.

Where the Verses Stand

Psalm 90 contrasts God’s eternity with man’s brevity. 2 Peter 3 answers scoffers about the promise.

Verse	KJV text	What to observe
Ps 90:1–4	“Lord, thou hast been our dwelling place in all generations. Before the mountains were brought forth, or ever thou hadst formed the earth and the world, even from everlasting to everlasting, thou art God. Thou turnest man to destruction; and sayest, Return, ye children of men. For a thousand years in thy sight are but as yesterday when it is past, and as a watch in the night.”	“From everlasting to everlasting”; “a thousand years in thy sight are but as yesterday.”
Ps 90:12	“So teach us to number our days, that we may apply our hearts unto wisdom.”	“So teach us to number our days.”
2Pet 3:3–4	“Knowing this first, that there shall come in the last days scoffers, walking after their own lusts, And saying, Where is the promise of his coming? for since the fathers fell asleep, all things continue as they were from the beginning of the creation.”	Scoffers: “Where is the promise of his coming?”
2Pet 3:8–9	“But, beloved, be not ignorant of this one thing, that one day is with the Lord as a thousand years, and a thousand years as one day. The Lord is not slack concerning his promise, as some men count slackness; but is longsuffering to us-ward, not willing that any should perish, but that all should come to repentance.”	“One day is with the Lord as a thousand years”; “not slack” and “longsuffering.”
Rev 20:6	“Blessed and holy is he that hath part in the first resurrection: on such the second death hath no power, but they shall be priests of God and of Christ, and shall reign with him a thousand years.”	“Reign with him a thousand years.”

What Carries the Weight

Stated: the psalm speaks of God's eternity.

Shown by the context: Peter answers scoffers.

Inferred: the psalm is not a timetable.

The Other Readings

Prophetic formula: strains at the psalm's meaning.

No relevance: strains at Peter's use.

Corrective use: fits both.

Reading	What it must say	Where it strains
A day-age formula	One day equals a thousand years.	Peter's saying runs both ways.
Revelation's thousand years are symbolic	3:8 shows the number is not literal.	Peter does not mention Revelation 20.
God is not bound by time	The verse answers delay with longsuffering.	None; it follows 3:9.

What It Means for the Reader

God's time is not man's; delay is not denial.

Related Reading

Commentary Series: Prophecy & Mystery Commentary, Volume 3 (The Kingdom Program). **Companions:** Psalms; 2 Peter.

9. What Is the “Rest” in Psalm 95 and Hebrews 3–4?

Israel’s rest, the warning, and the promise

THE ANSWER

Psalm 95 warns Israel not to repeat the wilderness refusal. Hebrews applies the warning to Hebrew believers and speaks of a rest still open. The rest is Israel’s promised rest; the warning is present.

Where the Verses Stand

Psalm 95 recalls Meribah. Hebrews warns its readers and speaks of a rest remaining.

Verse	KJV text	What to observe
Num 14:21–23	“But as truly as I live, all the earth shall be filled with the glory of the LORD. Because all those men which have seen my glory, and my miracles, which I did in Egypt and in the wilderness, and have tempted me now these ten times, and have not hearkened to my voice; Surely they shall not see the land which I sware unto their fathers, neither shall any of them that provoked me see it:”	“They shall not see the land which I sware unto their fathers.”
Ps 95:7–11	“For he is our God; and we are the people of his pasture, and the sheep of his hand. To day if ye will hear his voice, Harden not your heart, as in the provocation, and as in the day of temptation in the wilderness: When your fathers tempted me, proved me, and saw my work. Forty years long was I grieved with this generation, and said, It is a people that do err in their heart, and they have not known my ways: Unto whom I sware in my wrath that they should not enter into my rest.”	“To day if ye will hear his voice, Harden not your heart … they should not enter into my rest.”
Heb 3:7–11	“Wherefore (as the Holy Ghost saith, To day if ye will hear his voice, Harden not your hearts, as in the provocation, in the day of temptation in the wilderness: When your fathers tempted me, proved me, and saw my works forty years. Wherefore I was grieved with that generation, and said, They do alway err in their heart; and they have not known my ways. So I sware in my wrath, They shall not enter into my rest.)”	The psalm quoted, introduced by “the Holy Ghost saith.”

Heb 3:18–19	"And to whom sware he that they should not enter into his rest, but to them that believed not? So we see that they could not enter in because of unbelief."	"They could not enter in because of unbelief."
Heb 4:1–3	"Let us therefore fear, lest, a promise being left us of entering into his rest, any of you should seem to come short of it. For unto us was the gospel preached, as well as unto them: but the word preached did not profit them, not being mixed with faith in them that heard it. For we which have believed do enter into rest, as he said, As I have sworn in my wrath, if they shall enter into my rest: although the works were finished from the foundation of the world."	"A promise being left us of entering into his rest."
Heb 4:8–9	"For if Jesus had given them rest, then would he not afterward have spoken of another day. There remaineth therefore a rest to the people of God."	"If Jesus had given them rest … There remaineth therefore a rest."

What Carries the Weight

Stated: the psalm warns Israel.

Shown by the context: Hebrews applies the warning to Hebrews.

Inferred: the rest is Israel's promised rest.

The Other Readings

Heaven: strains at the psalm's warning.

Salvation: strains at the context.

Israel's rest: fits both.

Reading	What it must say	Where it strains
Salvation rest now	Any believer rests in Christ.	The land; "another day."
Heaven	The rest is the believer's home.	Joshua and the wilderness.
A rest for Israel, still ahead	The rest is the promised rest.	None; it follows the letter's audience.

What It Means for the Reader

The warning stands; the rest is God's.

Related Reading

Companions: Psalms; Hebrews.

10. What Does “This Day Have I Begotten Thee” Mean?

Psalm 2:7, Acts 13:33, and Hebrews 1:5

THE ANSWER

Psalm 2 speaks of the king God sets on Zion. Acts 13 applies the line to the resurrection; Hebrews applies it to sonship. The psalm’s line is used in two settings without merging them.

Where the Verses Stand

Psalm 2 speaks of God’s king. Acts 13 applies the line to resurrection. Hebrews 1 applies it to sonship.

Verse	KJV text	What to observe
Ps 2:1–2	“Why do the heathen rage, and the people imagine a vain thing? The kings of the earth set themselves, and the rulers take counsel together, against the LORD, and against his anointed, saying,”	The nations rage “against the LORD, and against his anointed.”
Ps 2:7–9	“I will declare the decree: the LORD hath said unto me, Thou art my Son; this day have I begotten thee. Ask of me, and I shall give thee the heathen for thine inheritance, and the uttermost parts of the earth for thy possession. Thou shalt break them with a rod of iron; thou shalt dash them in pieces like a potter's vessel.”	“Thou art my Son; this day have I begotten thee … the heathen for thine inheritance.”
Ac 13:32–34	“And we declare unto you glad tidings, how that the promise which was made unto the fathers, God hath fulfilled the same unto us their children, in that he hath raised up Jesus again; as it is also written in the second psalm, Thou art my Son, this day have I begotten thee. And as concerning that he raised him up from the dead, now no more to return to corruption, he said on this wise, I will give you the sure mercies of David.”	“Raised up Jesus again; as it is also written in the second psalm.”
Heb 1:5	“For unto which of the angels said he at any time, Thou art my Son, this day have I begotten thee? And again, I will be to him a Father, and he shall be to me a Son?”	“For unto which of the angels said he at any time”
Heb 5:5	“So also Christ glorified not himself to be made an high priest; but he that said unto him, Thou art my Son, to day have I begotten thee.”	“Christ glorified not himself to be made an high priest.”

Rom 1:3–4	"Concerning his Son Jesus Christ our Lord, which was made of the seed of David according to the flesh; And declared to be the Son of God with power, according to the spirit of holiness, by the resurrection from the dead:"	"Declared to be the Son of God with power … by the resurrection."

What Carries the Weight

Stated: the psalm speaks of God's king.

Shown by the context: Acts applies it to resurrection; Hebrews to sonship.

Inferred: the line is used in two settings.

The Other Readings

Only resurrection: strains at Hebrews.

Only sonship: strains at Acts.

Two uses: fits both.

Reading	What it must say	Where it strains
He became Son at the resurrection	"This day" is his beginning.	Hebrews 1:5; "declared."
An eternal begetting	The line speaks of eternity.	Acts 13:33; Romans 1:4.
A declaration at exaltation	"This day" is when he was shown to be Son.	None; it fits all three texts.

What It Means for the Reader

The psalm's line is true in both settings without merging them.

Related Reading

Companions: Psalms; Acts; Hebrews.

Passages Quoted in This Volume

Each passage is printed in full in the KJV table of the entry named.

Passage	Where it is read
Ps 22:1–2	Entry 1
Ps 22:7–8	Entry 1
Ps 22:18	Entry 1
Matt 27:35	Entry 1
Matt 27:39–43	Entry 1
Matt 27:45–47	Entry 1
Ps 22:21	Entry 1
Ps 22:24	Entry 1
Luke 23:46	Entry 1
Heb 2:10–12	Entry 1
Ps 82:1–4	Entry 2
Ps 82:6–8	Entry 2
Exod 22:8–9	Entry 2
John 10:30–33	Entry 2
John 10:34–36	Entry 2
John 10:37–38	Entry 2
Ps 91:1–2	Entry 3
Ps 91:9–12	Entry 3
Matt 4:5–7	Entry 3
Luke 4:9–12	Entry 3
Deut 6:16	Entry 3
Exod 17:7	Entry 3
Ps 8:3–6	Entry 4
Heb 2:5–8	Entry 4
Heb 2:9	Entry 4
Heb 2:16	Entry 4
Matt 21:15–16	Entry 4
1Cor 15:25–27	Entry 4
Ps 69:25	Entry 5
Ps 109:4–8	Entry 5

Acts 1:16	Entry 5
Acts 1:20	Entry 5
Matt 5:44	Entry 5
Rom 12:14	Entry 5
Rom 12:19	Entry 5
2Tim 4:14	Entry 5
Ps 4:4	Entry 6
Eph 4:25–27	Entry 6
Eph 4:31	Entry 6
Ps 68:17–18	Entry 7
Eph 4:7–10	Entry 7
Eph 4:11–13	Entry 7
Judg 5:12	Entry 7
Col 2:15	Entry 7
Ps 90:1–4	Entry 8
Ps 90:12	Entry 8
2Pet 3:3–4	Entry 8
2Pet 3:8–9	Entry 8
Rev 20:6	Entry 8
Num 14:21–23	Entry 9
Ps 95:7–11	Entry 9
Heb 3:7–11	Entry 9
Heb 3:18–19	Entry 9
Heb 4:1–3	Entry 9
Heb 4:8–9	Entry 9
Ps 2:1–2	Entry 10
Ps 2:7–9	Entry 10
Acts 13:32–34	Entry 10
Heb 1:5	Entry 10
Heb 5:5	Entry 10
Rom 1:3–4	Entry 10

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